

Lesson 15

Types of Data Used in Dashboards

1. **Categorical:** Data that represents categories such as department, region, or product.
2. **Quantitative:** Numerical data such as sales, calls handled, or uptime.
3. **Time-Series:** Data showing trends over time (e.g., hours, days, or months).
4. **Comparative:** Data comparing actual performance against targets or year-over-year data.
5. **Status Indicators:** Alerts, thresholds, and exceptions that signal specific conditions.

Focus: Prioritize actionable metrics that can drive decision-making.

Identifying Dashboard Data Types

- **Categorical Data:** For example, services like visa and passport information.
 - **Quantitative Data:** Numerical data such as citizen services numbers.
 - **Time-Series Data:** Trends such as visa issuance over time.
 - **Comparative Data:** For example, text boxes showing a percentage decrease in data.
 - **Status Indicators:** For example, a 3-day visa issuance time threshold.
-

Performance Dashboards

Performance dashboards focus on:

- **Strategy Execution:** Tracking progress against strategic goals.
- **Monitoring:** Observing performance in real time.
- **Collaborative:** Enabling teamwork and shared insights.
- **Corrections:** Making adjustments based on real-time feedback.
- **Objective Transparency:** Providing clear insights into goals and performance.

Framework: The performance dashboard framework is based on the book *Performance Dashboards: Measuring, Monitoring, and Managing Your Business* by Eckerson.

Performance Dashboard Layers

- **Graphical Abstracted Data:** Graphs, charts, and symbols for quick insights.
- **Summarized Dimensional Data:** Dimensions and hierarchies for analysis (slice/dice).
- **Detailed Operational Data:** In-depth data for operational decision-making.

- **Reporting:** Operational reports and planning updates such as forecasts and models.
-

Examples of Performance Dashboards

- [Vahan Dashboard](#): An example of a performance dashboard displaying vehicle data.
-

Mistakes in Dashboard Design (Stephen Few)

1. Exceeding the boundaries of a single screen.
 2. Supplying inadequate context for the data.
 3. Displaying excessive detail or precision.
 4. Choosing a deficient measure.
 5. Choosing inappropriate display media.
 6. Designing unattractive visual displays.
 7. Introducing meaningless variety.
 8. Using poorly designed display media.
 9. Encoding quantitative data inaccurately.
 10. Poor arrangement of data.
 11. Ineffective or absent highlighting of important data.
 12. Cluttering the display with unnecessary decoration.
 13. Misusing or overusing color.
-